



CLOUDKART

Delivery Issues Guide

Shipping & Orders Knowledge Base

Covers shipping delays, customs holds, lost packages, delivered-but-missing reports, carrier exception codes, and wrong or damaged item arrivals.

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1. Overview

This guide addresses problems that occur after an order has shipped: delays, lost packages, delivered-but-missing reports, and carrier exceptions. It complements the Shipping Policy, which covers the standard, non-problematic delivery process.

The most important initial step for any delivery issue is to check the tracking page before doing anything else. Many cases that appear to be problems are actually in a normal state — the tracking page often explains what's happening and provides the expected next update date, which allows an agent to reassure the customer rather than escalating prematurely.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer says their package is 'lost' because it hasn't arrived.

Resolution: Check tracking first — 'in transit' with recent scans is not lost. Only treat as potentially lost when there are no scans beyond the delay thresholds in Section 2.

Scenario: Customer says their package was delivered but they're unhappy with the carrier.

Resolution: If delivered: direct to Section 5 (Marked Delivered but Not Received). If just a complaint about service: log feedback but no action needed unless the item is genuinely missing.

2. When a Delay Becomes Actionable

A delay does not necessarily mean a package is lost. This section defines when a delay becomes actionable.

Shipping Method	Considered Delayed When	Recommended First Action
Standard domestic	Past window by 3+ business days	Check tracking for last scan; if no scan in 5+ days, treat as Section 4
Express domestic	Past window by 1+ business day	Check tracking, then escalate to carrier if no movement
Standard international	Past window by 5+ business days	Check for a customs hold scan before escalating
Express international	Past window by 2+ business days	Check for a customs hold scan before escalating

Worked Examples

Scenario: Standard domestic order placed 7 days ago, not delivered, estimated window was 5 days.

Resolution: 2 days past the window — check tracking. If there's been a scan within the last 2 days, still in transit. If no scan in 5+ days, open a carrier trace.

Scenario: Express international order is 1 day past the estimated window.

Resolution: Check for a customs hold scan; if present, see Section 3. If no customs scan and no movement, contact the carrier to open a trace.

3. Customs Holds

Customs holds are a common cause of international delays and are not within CloudKart's control once the package leaves the origin country.

- A customs hold typically appears as 'Held by Customs' or similar wording in the tracking timeline.
- Most customs holds resolve automatically within 5–10 business days.
- If a hold exceeds 15 business days, the customer can be advised to contact local customs directly, as they may need to confirm details or pay duties.
- CloudKart cannot expedite a customs hold; agents should set this expectation clearly rather than promising a resolution timeline.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer's international package has been 'Held by Customs' for 6 business days.

Resolution: Normal — most customs holds resolve within 5–10 days. Reassure the customer and advise monitoring the tracking for the release scan.

Scenario: Customer's package has been held by customs for 20 business days.

Resolution: Unusual — advise the customer to contact their national customs agency with the tracking number; they may need to provide additional documentation or pay duties.

4. Lost Package Process

A package is treated as potentially lost when tracking shows no scan activity for an extended period with no explanatory customs hold.

- 1 Confirm the shipping address on the order was correct and complete.
- 2 Check whether the carrier's tracking page shows any exception code explaining the gap (see Section 6).
- 3 If no explanation is found and the last scan is older than the thresholds in Section 2, file a carrier trace request through the Order Console; most carriers respond within 5–7 business days.
- 4 If the carrier confirms the package is lost, or doesn't respond within 10 business days, offer the customer free reshipment or full refund, customer's choice.

Important

Do not offer reshipment or refund for a 'lost' package before the carrier trace step unless the order is significantly overdue with zero tracking scans since shipment — packages frequently reappear during the trace window.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Standard domestic package has had no scan for 8 business days.

Resolution: Well past the 5-day threshold — file a carrier trace immediately. Do not reship yet; wait for the trace result.

Scenario: Carrier trace comes back 'package confirmed lost'.

Resolution: Offer the customer free reshipment of the same item or a full refund; document the carrier's confirmation in the ticket.

5. Marked Delivered but Not Received

These cases are emotionally sensitive for customers and should be handled efficiently, since the customer is certain something is wrong while tracking says otherwise.

- 1 Ask the customer to check around the delivery location: porches, mailrooms, with neighbours, or building management — a large share resolve this way within 24–48 hours.
- 2 Confirm the delivery address on the order matches where the customer expected delivery, including unit or apartment numbers.
- 3 Check the tracking page for a delivery photo or signature, if the carrier provides one, and share relevant details with the customer.
- 4 If unresolved after 48 hours, file a missing-package claim with the carrier and offer the customer a reshipment or refund pending the claim outcome.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Tracking shows 'Delivered' but customer insists they never received it.

Resolution: Ask them to check with neighbours and the building's mailroom or front desk first; wait 24–48 hours before escalating as many packages turn up this way.

Scenario: Carrier delivery photo shows the package at a porch that isn't the customer's.

Resolution: Share the photo with the customer to review; if it's the wrong address, contact the carrier immediately with the photo evidence to open a misdelivery claim.

6. Carrier Exception Codes

Carriers use standardised exception codes on tracking pages to explain why a package didn't move as expected. Recognising these speeds up triage significantly.

Exception Type	Typical Meaning	Typical Resolution
Address Issue	Carrier could not read or locate the address	Carrier usually attempts redelivery after correction
Weather Delay	Regional weather disrupting operations	Resolves automatically once conditions clear
Held at Facility	Package paused at a sorting facility	Usually resolves within 1–3 business days
Customs Hold	Awaiting customs clearance	See Section 3
Delivery Attempted	Carrier attempted, no one available	Carrier typically retries 1–3 times before return

Worked Examples

Scenario: Tracking shows 'Address Issue' exception.

Resolution: Contact the carrier with the correct address; if the order is still in the carrier's system, they can usually reattempt delivery without a full reshipment.

Scenario: Tracking shows 'Weather Delay' exception.

Resolution: No action needed — this resolves automatically. Reassure the customer and monitor; only escalate if the delay exceeds 5 business days post-weather-event.

7. Wrong, Missing, or Damaged Items on Arrival

Some orders arrive with the wrong item, missing items, or visible shipping damage. These are warehouse fulfillment issues rather than carrier transit issues.

- **Wrong item received:** Customer is not required to return the incorrect item before a replacement ships, unless it is of significantly higher value.
- **Missing item from a multi-item order:** Verify against the original order whether the item shipped separately before assuming it's missing.
- **Visible shipping damage:** Treated under the Returns & Exchanges document's damaged-item process, not as a delivery issue.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer received a blue mug but ordered a green one.

Resolution: Wrong item — ship the correct green mug immediately; no need to wait for the wrong one to come back unless the retail value is very high.

Scenario: Customer ordered 3 items, only 2 are in the box.

Resolution: Check for a split shipment first; if the third item has a separate tracking number it's on its way. If no second tracking exists, this is a fulfillment error — reship the missing item.

8. Routing Reference

Routing guidance to help the support chatbot distinguish delivery issues from adjacent categories.

Customer Phrase Pattern	Route To
'order hasn't shipped'	shipping_policy.pdf, Section 3
'package says delivered but I don't have it'	delivery_issues.pdf, Section 5
'tracking hasn't moved in days'	delivery_issues.pdf, Section 4
'held by customs'	delivery_issues.pdf, Section 3
'want to return this item'	returns.pdf
'received the wrong item'	delivery_issues.pdf, Section 7

Worked Examples

Scenario: Chatbot receives: 'where is my package?'

Resolution: Retrieve the order status and tracking link from the order lookup tool; if tracking shows an exception, surface the appropriate section of this guide.

Scenario: Chatbot receives: 'I got the wrong thing'.

Resolution: Route to delivery_issues.pdf Section 7 (wrong item received) and offer to initiate a replacement shipment via the agent handoff flow.

9. Quick Reference: Delivery Issue Routing

This quick reference maps delivery issue types to the correct response path, helping agents handle emotionally charged delivery complaints systematically.

Situation	Section	First Action
No tracking scans for extended period	4 – Lost Package	File carrier trace; don't reship yet
Tracking shows 'Delivered' but not received	5 – Marked Delivered	Ask customer to check neighbours/mailroom; wait 48h
Customs hold	3 – Customs Holds	Reassure; most resolve in 5–10 days automatically
Carrier exception code shown	6 – Exception Codes	Identify exception type; take action per table
Wrong item arrived	7 – Wrong/Missing Items	Ship correct item immediately; no return required first
Item missing from multi-item order	7 – Wrong/Missing Items	Check for split shipment before assuming fulfilment error

Worked Examples

Scenario: Agent receives three 'package not received' reports in one hour.

Resolution: Check whether all orders used the same carrier and shipped from the same warehouse — simultaneous reports may indicate a carrier or facility issue that should be flagged to the shipping operations team.

Scenario: Customer is upset and demanding a refund for a delayed package.

Resolution: Acknowledge the frustration, confirm the tracking status, and set a clear timeline: if within the delay thresholds of Section 2, the package is still in transit; offer proactive contact once it's delivered or if thresholds are breached.

Appendix A: Claim Response Time Targets

Service level targets for carrier traces and missing-package claims.

Claim Type	Region	Target Response Time
Carrier trace request	Domestic	5–7 business days
Carrier trace request	International	10–15 business days
Missing-package claim	Domestic	3–5 business days
Missing-package claim	International	7–10 business days